

4. This will display the Properties dialog box for your Flash drive or other removable media device
5. Click the ReadyBoost tab, and then do one of the following:
 - To turn ReadyBoost off, click 'Do not use this device'
 - To turn ReadyBoost on, click 'Use this device', and then move the slider to choose how much of the available space on your Flash drive you want to reserve for boosting your system speed
6. Click OK

Note

The removable device must contain at least 256 MB of free space to work with Windows ReadyBoost. The recommended amount of memory to use for ReadyBoost acceleration is one to three times the amount of RAM installed in your system. If your PC has 512 MB of RAM and you plug in a 4 GB USB Flash drive, setting aside space between 512 MB to 1.5 GB on that drive will offer the best performance boost.

3.8.2 ReadyDrive

Recently announced were hybrid disk drives which were part non-volatile Flash memory (NVRAM) and part regular hard disk. Such H-HDDs, as they are called, should soon become regular features of our computer systems. Typically, H-HDDs include between 50 MB and 512 MB of Flash memory. Much like ReadyBoost, Windows Vista will make use of this Flash capacity to store frequently used data as cache. Vista can, for example store boot data to the cache when the system shuts down or hibernates. This should allow faster restarting or resuming, respectively. The cache can also be used as a scratchpad for data reads and writes even when the hard drive has spun down—this should reduce the power consumed by the disk under normal usage; once again a plus point for laptop owners.

3.8.3 ReadyBoot

When a Windows system boots, a large number of files need to be read into memory and processed. Typically, the files which need to be called upon boot depend on which services and startup programs the user requires to start the system up. This process can be